



Narrative Essay Writing: Body Paragraphs and Conclusion

Expository Writing- Week 8

Narrative Essay Organization (Body and Conclusion)

- **Paragraph 2: Rising Action** – Develops a problem or conflict leading up to the climax and provides supporting details
- **Paragraph 3: Climax** – Clearly develops the turning point of the story where the problem or conflict reaches its peak and provides supporting details
- **Paragraph 4: Falling Action** – Clearly develops the events after the climax or turning point that leads to the resolution and provides supporting details
- **Conclusion: Resolution** – Clearly reveals the solution to the problem. Rephrasing thesis. Provides a concluding remark/statement



Essay Type	Thesis Structure	Supporting Aspects	Example Thesis
Expository Essay	Topic + Main Idea/Claim + Supporting Points	Point 1: First explanation or reason Point 2: Second explanation or reason Point 3: Third explanation or reason	Online education benefits students by improving flexibility, reducing costs, and expanding access to learning.
Descriptive Essay	Topic + Claim / Expression + Supporting Descriptions	Physical Description: Sensory details about appearance (sight, smell, sound, texture). Contextual Description: Background, setting, or environment surrounding the subject. Emotional Description: Feelings, memories, or personal reactions associated with the subject.	My grandmother’s kitchen is a place of warmth and nostalgia, filled with the aroma of freshly baked bread, the soft glow of antique lamps, and memories of summers spent baking cookies together.
Narrative Essay	Lesson + Story Experience + Supporting Plot Events	Rising Action: Events that develop the conflict or problem and build tension in the story. Climax: The most intense moment when the main conflict reaches its peak. Falling Action / Resolution: Events after the climax that show how the problem is resolved and what the narrator learns.	Getting lost during my first solo journey taught me the importance of patience and independence as I wandered, searching for directions, confronted panic, and finally gained the confidence to trust my own decisions.



Introductory Paragraph – Personal Narrative

Anecdote

Lead-in

Thesis

Transitional
hook with 2
forward points

The moment my name was announced, my hands turned cold and my heart began to race uncontrollably. I remember standing backstage on the day of my first public presentation, the bright lights ahead and the low murmur of the audience filling the room. As someone who had always avoided speaking in front of others, I felt completely unprepared for what lay ahead. Facing my fear of public speaking helped me grow as a person by teaching me to manage anxiety, build confidence, and express myself clearly. As I walked onto the stage, my overwhelming anxiety and fear of failure began to shape the challenges I had to confront.



Rising Action

What is Rising Action?

- Introduces the problem or conflict
- Builds tension and curiosity
- Leads toward the climax

Focus: Building the conflict

Main Agenda: Show what goes wrong and how the character reacts

What to Include

- Clear problem/conflict
- Feelings and reactions
- Sensory details (see, hear, feel)
- Internal dialogue

Why?: Engages the reader, makes the story real and vivid, and prepares for the turning point

Choice of Words:

- **Purpose Words (show problem/conflict):** *suddenly, unexpectedly, unfortunately, at that moment, things began to go wrong, everything changed, the situation worsened, sensory descriptions*
- **Feelings (negative/emotional tension):** *anxious, nervous, terrified, uneasy, overwhelmed, confused, worried, panicked, stressed, figurative devices*
- **Actions/Reactions:** *trembled, froze, hesitated, struggled, avoided, couldn't speak, lost focus, stepped back*
- **Internal Dialogue:** *What if I fail?, I can't do this, Something is wrong.*



Body Paragraph 1: Rising Action

Reverse Hook with 2 Controlling Ideas

1st Major Detail: Sensory Details with Concrete Description

2nd Major Detail: Internal Dialogue and conflict introduced

Minor Details: Development of the Problem

Transitional Hook with 2 Controlling Ideas

As I stepped forward, my intense nervousness and fear of making mistakes started to overwhelm me. My hands trembled, my throat felt dry, and the bright lights blurred my vision, while the faint whispers of the audience echoed in my ears. “What if I forget everything?” I kept asking myself. For a few seconds, I stood frozen, unable to begin. The pressure of expectations and my own self-doubt made the situation feel even more difficult to handle. At that moment, my growing determination and inner courage began to challenge my fear.



Climax

- **What is Climax?**

- The turning point of the story
- The moment of highest tension
- Where the conflict reaches its peak
- **Focus:** The most important moment
- **Main Agenda:** Show the decision or action that changes everything

- **What to Include**

- A key decision or action
- Strong emotions
- Clear change in direction

Why?: Creates maximum impact, Shows transformation, Keeps the reader fully engaged

Choice of Words:

- **Decision Words:** *finally, at last, in that moment, then, I realized, I decided, I chose to*
- **Strong Action Verbs:** *took a deep breath, stepped forward, spoke up, acted, faced, confronted, pushed myself*
- **Emotional Shift:** *suddenly, instantly, at once, a sense of courage, a spark of confidence*
- **Realization Phrases:** *I understood that..., That was the moment when..., I knew I had to...*



Body Paragraph 2: Climax

Reverse Hook with 2 Controlling Ideas

1st Major Detail: Key Action / Decision

2nd Major Detail: Peak Emotional Intensity

Minor Details: Turning Point Insight

Transitional Hook with 2 Controlling Ideas

As my perseverance and self-belief started to replace my fear, I realized I had to make a choice. Taking a deep breath, I finally began to speak, even though my voice was slightly shaky. I focused on delivering my ideas instead of worrying about perfection. With each sentence, my confidence increased, and my fear slowly faded away. This was the moment I stopped letting fear control me and started believing in myself. As I continued speaking, my rising confidence and sense of control started to transform my experience.



Falling Action

- **What is Falling Action?**

- Events that happen after the climax
- Shows how the conflict begins to resolve
- Leads toward the resolution
- **Focus:** Moving toward the solution
- **Main Agenda:** Show what happens after the turning point
- **What to Include:**
 - Events after climax
 - Reactions and outcomes
 - Signs of improvement/change

Why?: Shows progress, Highlights growth, Prepares for the ending

Choice of Words

- **Sequence Words:** *after that, gradually, slowly, soon, as I continued, little by little*
- **Positive Feelings:** *relieved, calm, confident, proud, satisfied, hopeful, at ease*
- **Outcome Words:** *things improved, the situation changed, everything became easier, I managed to, I was able to*
- **Reactions:** *people smiled, nodded, responded positively, the atmosphere became relaxed*



Body Paragraph 3: Falling Action

**Reverse Hook with 2
Controlling Ideas**

**1st Major Detail:
Events After Climax**

**2nd Major Detail:
Resolution in
Progress**

Outcome

As my growing self-assurance and calmness replaced my earlier fear, I began to notice a change within myself. I noticed the audience listening attentively, some even nodding in agreement. My voice became steadier, and I was able to express my ideas clearly. When I finished, the applause filled the room, and a deep sense of relief washed over me. The fear that once controlled me no longer seemed powerful.



Conclusion-Resolution

- **What is Resolution?**

- The final part of the story
- Shows how the problem is solved
- Reveals the lesson or meaning
- **Focus:** Final message and reflection
- **Main Agenda:** Show what the experience means

- **What to Include**

- Clear solution
- Rephrased thesis
- Strong closing statement

Why?: Gives a complete ending, Shows learning and growth, Leaves a lasting impression

Choice of Words:

- **Reflection Words:** *this experience taught me, I learned that, I realized that*
- **Rephrasing Thesis:** *I became more confident, I overcame my fear, I grew as a person*
- **Ending Words:** *from that day on, ever since then, in the future*
- **Strong Closing Lines:** *This moment changed me forever, it was a lesson I will never forget*



Conclusion: Resolution

Resolution

Restating of Thesis

Concluding Remark

This experience showed me that fear can be overcome with courage and persistence. Learning to manage my anxiety, build confidence, and express myself clearly helped me grow both as a speaker and as a person. From that day onward, I no longer avoided challenges but embraced them as opportunities for growth.



In-Class Task

- Complete the essay in groups of five based on the introductory paragraph written in Week 7 and present it in the class.

